Celebrating a Relationship Built on Heritage, Strengthened by Trade, and Inspired by Opportunity.

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Foreword

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI INDIA) has, since its inception, worked to widen the horizon of Indian enterprise beyond its traditional and well-trodden trade partnerships. As global supply chains are redrawn amid geopolitical realignment, the search for new, resilient and mutually beneficial markets has become a strategic imperative for Indian industry. It is in this context that CCI INDIA presents this Knowledge Paper on India–Georgia economic cooperation.

Georgia, a small yet strategically located economy at the crossroads of Europe and Asia, has in recent years emerged as one of the fastest-growing and most reform-oriented economies in the wider Eurasian region. Its position astride the Middle Corridor the Trans-Caspian International Transport Route linking China and Central Asia with Europe via the Caspian Sea, the South Caucasus and the Black Sea gives it a connectivity value that far exceeds the size of its domestic market. For Indian businesses seeking diversified, de-risked and future-ready trade routes into Europe, Georgia's Free Trade Agreements with the European Union, China, and other major markets present an underutilised gateway.

India and Georgia share a long and cordial diplomatic relationship, dating to India's early recognition of Georgian independence in December 1991. Yet the economic relationship between the two nations remains modest relative to its potential, with bilateral trade still measured in tens of millions of dollars rather than the hundreds of millions that the complementarities between the two economies would justify. This gap between diplomatic goodwill and commercial engagement represents precisely the space in which institutions such as CCI INDIA can add the greatest value.

CCI INDIA remains committed to strengthening India's economic diplomacy at the institutional level, and to ensuring that the opportunities identified in this report translate into concrete commercial outcomes for Indian industry, particularly micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) for whom the Middle Corridor and the Georgian market offer a genuine, if underexplored, frontier.



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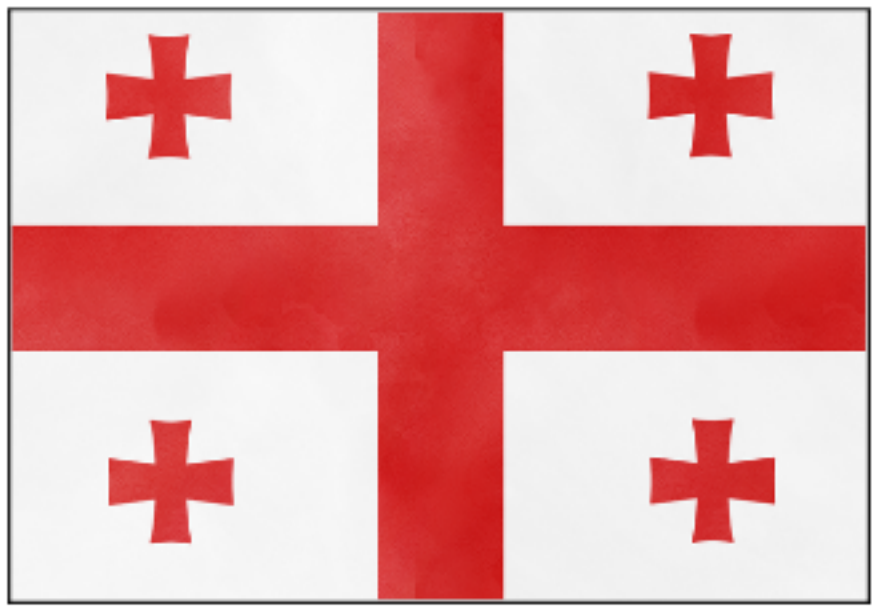
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GEORGIA

> Short distances, coastal towns, and scenic Mediterranean views make budget travel easy while allowing you to immerse yourself in local culture.



Basic Facts and Demographics

Georgia is a strategically located country in the Caucasus region, positioned at the crossroads of Eastern Europe and Western Asia. It has a population of approximately 3.9 million people, with Tbilisi as its capital and largest city. The official currency is the Georgian Lari (GEL).

Economic Landscape and Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

Georgia's GDP is approximately USD 38 billion, reflecting strong growth driven by tourism, logistics, trade, financial services, and infrastructure development. The country has implemented significant economic reforms to attract foreign direct investment and promote private sector development. Key areas of growth include infrastructure, energy, and logistics. Despite its relatively small economic size, Georgia has successfully integrated into regional and global markets. **The primary sectors contributing to GDP are:**

Agriculture: Agriculture plays an important role in rural employment, with key products including grapes (for wine production), fruits, vegetables, and livestock. Georgian wine is internationally recognized and contributes to export earnings.

Services: The service sector is the largest contributor to GDP, with tourism being a major driver. Georgia attracts international visitors due to its natural landscapes, cultural heritage, and affordable travel. Banking, trade, and hospitality services are also growing rapidly.

Industry: The industrial sector includes light manufacturing, mining, and energy production. Hydropower and natural resources support industrial activity, while construction contributes to infrastructure development.

Culture and Heritage

Georgia's heritage reaches back to ancient times, carrying stories that have shaped its people for thousands of years. It is often celebrated as one of the earliest regions to make wine, a practice still honored with pride. Historic buildings, lively music and dance, and flavorful dishes help define its character. With roots connected to both European and Asian traditions, Georgia offers a cultural blend that is rich, warm, and unforgettable.

Bilateral Trade With India — Value & Composition

India–Georgia trade has shown steady growth, supported by increasing connectivity and business interest.

- Total Trade (2024–25 est.): ~USD 250–350 million
- India's exports to Georgia: pharmaceuticals, machinery, textiles, chemicals
- India's imports from Georgia: metals, fertilizers, agricultural products

India is also a significant contributor to education services, with many Indian students studying medicine in Georgia.

Economic & Strategic Areas Of Cooperation

Key areas of cooperation between India and Georgia include:

- Pharmaceutical exports and healthcare services
- Education (medical and technical studies)
- Tourism and hospitality sector growth
- Logistics and transport corridors
- IT and digital services

Georgia's role as a gateway to Europe and Central Asia enhances its attractiveness for Indian businesses.



Cultural & People-To-People Links

Cultural ties between India and Georgia are growing:

- Increasing number of Indian students in Georgian universities
- Rising tourism exchanges
- Interest in Indian culture, cinema, and cuisine

These connections are strengthening long-term engagement beyond trade.

Conclusion & Recommendations

Georgia is a dynamic, reform-driven economy with strategic importance as a transit hub between Europe and Asia.

Key Takeaways:

1. Georgia offers strong growth and a business-friendly environment
2. It serves as a gateway to wider regional markets
3. India–Georgia ties are expanding in trade, education, and tourism
4. Market size is small but strategically valuable



Chapter 1 Introduction and Strategic Context

1.1 Purpose of the Report

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared by CCI INDIA to provide a comprehensive, evidence-based assessment of the opportunities and constraints shaping India's economic engagement with Georgia, and to articulate a concrete institutional role for CCI INDIA in deepening that engagement. The report is intended for policymakers within the Government of India, Indian diplomatic missions, industry leaders, exporters, investors, and institutional partners considering the South Caucasus as a frontier market. It is structured to move from macroeconomic and sectoral analysis, through an assessment of existing diplomatic and institutional linkages, to a set of implementation-ready policy recommendations and a phased strategic roadmap.

The analysis draws on the latest available data (2024–2026) from the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the Asian Development Bank (ADB), the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD), Geostat (Georgia's National Statistics Office), the National Bank of Georgia, UN Comtrade, the International Trade Centre's Trade Map, and the Government of India's Ministry of Commerce and Industry, among other authoritative sources, in order to ensure that the recommendations offered are grounded in current economic realities rather than static assumptions about a fast-changing region.

1.2 Georgia's Geopolitical Importance

Georgia occupies a compact but consequential position in the South Caucasus, bordered by Russia to the north, Azerbaijan to the east, Armenia and Türkiye to the south, and the Black Sea to the west. This location places Georgia at the intersection of several of the twenty-first century's most consequential geo-economic developments: the reconfiguration of Eurasian trade routes following the Russia-Ukraine conflict, the European Union's search for diversified energy and connectivity partnerships in Central Asia, and the broader contest over transit infrastructure linking China, Central Asia, and Europe.

Since 2022, sanctions on Russia and the resulting decline in the use of the Northern Corridor (the traditional China–Russia–Europe rail route) have accelerated interest in alternative Eurasian transit routes, most notably the Middle Corridor. Georgia, along with Azerbaijan and Kazakhstan, has emerged as a core participant in this route, and has attracted growing attention and investment from the European Union, the World Bank, the EBRD, the Asian Development Bank, and the United States as a result.

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